



Winder Delfin, 17, and his brother Deivi, 15, were walking home when their building collapsed. They spent nearly a month searching for the bodies of family members.

Red Sea Strait Is Newest Risk For Global Oil

This article is by *Jenny Gross, Rebecca F. Elliott and Lisa Friedman.*

LONDON — Threats from the Iran-backed Houthi militant group this week to block Saudi Arabia's use of the Red Sea risk cutting off a crucial alternative path for Mideast oil and further destabilizing a global energy market upended by the war in Iran.

Since March, the Saudis have been moving millions of barrels of oil west each day through a pipeline and loading it onto tankers. From there, most of the vessels have navigated the Bab al-Mandab Strait, a waterway at the southern end of the Red Sea, mostly heading to customers in Asia.

Before the war, one-fifth of the world's oil passed through the Strait of Hormuz. Now, another choke point might be turned into a geopolitical weapon, underlining how drastically trade routes have been scrambled. Energy producers that devised workarounds to deliver shipments are now facing the possibility of needing to map new routes.

It was not apparent how or even whether the Houthis, who are based in Yemen, will carry through on their declaration, which they issued on Monday. But there were signs that the threat could be affecting sea traffic. Two oil tankers heading toward the Bab al-Mandab made U-turns and were moving north toward the Suez Canal, according to Kpler, a maritime data company. But that route can be costlier and logistically more complex.

On Tuesday, at least 93 crude oil tankers were operating in the Red Sea, a big increase from the approximately 50 tankers a day before the war, Kpler found, a reflection of the increased use of the Saudi port of Yanbu on the Red Sea. In recent months, Saudi Arabia has been exporting around 3.6 million barrels of oil and related fuels a day via the Bab al-Mandab Strait. Before the war, the Saudis

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FALLEN Mourning began for three U.S. soldiers who were killed last week in the Iran war. PAGE A8

Teenage Brothers in Grim Search Under Rubble

By **JULIE TURKEWITZ**

LA GUAIRA, Venezuela — He had hacked apart concrete and sawed through rebar and pressed on through heat and dust and exhaustion, persevering as men far bigger and stronger collapsed.

Now, on Day 25 of his search, Winder Delfin, age 17, had finally found what he was looking for. Deep in the tunnel he had dug with his brother Deivi, age 15, his father and his stepfather, Winder could make out the flower-print dress that belonged to his grandmother.

He hoped his mother and little brother were just beyond.

After Quakes, Families in Venezuela Look for Loved Ones

“There are bodies nearby,” he said, looking up at his father from the edge of the tunnel.

A month after a pair of history-making earthquakes ripped across Venezuela, the country's hardest-hit state, La Guaira, remains a scene of grueling, painstaking searches for the dead. From dawn until far past dusk, thousands of survivors fan out

across the remains of the residences that once stood just blocks from the beach, climbing onto the mountains of rubble with pick-axes and sledgehammers, fueled by an obsessive desire to recover the bodies of the people they loved.

Officially the death toll is 5,278, but the government has said it could be as high as 10,000.

The hands of the searchers bleed. Dust coats their lungs and reddens their eyes. At night, some sleep atop the debris, too tired to go anywhere else. They live on donated sandwiches and plastic thimbles of coffee and the hope

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Free of Virus, but Scarred by 42-Day Quarantine

By **APOORVA MANDAVILLI**

The mood inside the National Quarantine Unit was electric with despair and fury.

It was May 17, six days after United States health officials had evacuated 18 Americans from the cruise ship at the center of a hantavirus outbreak that had killed three people, and taken them to the special facility in Omaha for what they had said would be a quick 72-hour evaluation before the passengers could go home to quarantine.

None of them had tested positive for the virus, but now an official from the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Dr. David Fitter, was telling them on a video call that they would not be permitted to leave for at least two more weeks.

These were people who had paid thousands of dollars for a cruise through uninhabited regions, in pursuit of exotic birds and animals. They chafed against the loss of fresh air, nature and, most of all, their freedom.

“I’m asking you, as a scientist and a human,” a passenger with a redheaded woodpecker as his Zoom icon said to Dr. Fitter, on a copy of the video call viewed by The New York Times. “Do you think that this is really a sensible decision to keep me here in this room that’s making me sicker day by day, being here when I could be home isolating in a perfectly reasonable situation?”

Looking distinctly uncomfortable,



Dr. Steve Kornfeld of Bend, Ore., was among 18 Americans isolated in Omaha after a hantavirus outbreak aboard a cruise ship.

able, Dr. Fitter responded, “I think that the best that I have for you right now is that I will pass this up.”

News of the outbreak aboard a cruise ship, with its echoes of the early days of the Covid pandemic,

alarmed people around the world. The little-studied Andes hantavirus has a mortality rate of nearly 40 percent among hospitalized patients, prompting countries to evacuate their citizens

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Migrant Policy Creating Crisis For Elder Care

By **MIRIAM JORDAN**

PALO ALTO, Calif. — Channing House, a senior living community just a mile from Stanford University, is home to pioneering scientists, tech executives and inventors. But during a recent meeting, its residents confronted a problem they felt powerless to fix: the sudden loss of their caregivers to immigration policies.

“Our work force is being drastically disrupted, relationships are being severed and lives are being upended right now,” said Rhonda Bekkedahl, the center's chief executive, who convened the gathering in June that was attended by about half of the 250 residents of the community in Palo Alto, Calif.

The Trump administration's immigration crackdown is colliding with a demographic reality. Americans are aging rapidly and living longer, creating soaring demand for elder care when the industry is already buckling under the weight of chronic labor shortages.

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Maine Candidate’s Evolution: Anti-Abortion to Progressive

By **REID J. EPSTEIN and BETH REINHARD**

WASHINGTON — Today he is a progressive Democrat calling for “Medicare for all,” the abolition of Immigration and Customs Enforcement and a federal right to abortion.

But Troy Jackson got his start in politics as a Republican who was opposed to abortion rights and same-sex marriage.

Mr. Jackson, who is poised to become his party's new nominee for Senate in Maine after Graham Platner's departure, has completed a remarkable evolution on social issues since he started organizing fellow loggers in the state's northern tip in the 1990s.

As his political ambitions rose, Mr. Jackson, a former president of the Maine Senate, kept pushing his economic populist message.

U.S. ABANDONING FUEL EFFICIENCY AS PRICES SURGE

UNDOING REGULATIONS

New Data Centers and Record Heat Strain the Power Grid

By **BRAD PLUMER**

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is dismantling an array of federal energy-efficiency programs at the same time that the war in Iran is raising oil prices, climate change is fueling record heat that is driving up demand for air conditioning, and new data centers are straining America's electricity supply.

“The turn away from efficiency has been oddly timed,” said Christine Egan, the chief executive of CLASP, a nonprofit group that works on efficiency policies worldwide. “Energy prices are going up, demand is going up, and you'd think we would want our products to be as efficient as possible.”

The result is that consumers could end up using more electricity and burning more gas when electricity costs are rising faster than inflation and gasoline is averaging \$4 a gallon nationwide.

Though more efficient cars or appliances can be more expensive, consumers often save money over time because they use less energy.

Since the 1970s, administrations of both parties have issued regulations to reduce the amount of fuel used by cars, buildings and appliances to alleviate energy crunches. Those efficiency standards can also help curtail the emissions that are warming the planet.

President Trump has said the country faces an energy emergency and does not have enough power to meet its growing needs, including for data centers for artificial intelligence.

But administration officials say the answer is to generate more electricity and use more oil, gas, coal and nuclear power.

“The administration's focus is on expanding affordable, reliable and secure energy,” said Ben Dietrich, an Energy Department spokesman.

Mr. Trump has been a longtime critic of energy conservation rules, saying they limit consumer choice and ruin appliances. Over the past year, the administration has proposed rescinding requirements that manufacturers make washing machines and other appliances that use less electricity and water.

The government has relaxed fuel-economy rules for new cars

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‘Gooooooooooal’ 308 Times

The World Cup, with the field expanded to 48 teams, set a record for goals. Miss any? Here's a refresher. PAGES B8-11

Major Leaguers’ Plan B

Day trader? Firefighter? All-Stars were asked what they might be doing if they weren't playing baseball. PAGE B6

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Zelensky Fires Top General

The decision came after public protests over the firing of a popular defense minister threatened the unity behind Ukraine's wartime resilience. PAGE A9

Fleeing Ontario’s Blazes

Residents helped neighbors escape, sometimes in small boats, and wondered why warnings came late. PAGE A4

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Border City Hangs in Balance

The economy of Laredo, Texas, boomed under Trump's global tariffs. Now his demands threaten its success. PAGE B1

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Trump Blocks Medicaid Funds

The administration withholds \$1 billion as it accuses California and Minnesota of fraudulent activity in their public health insurance programs. PAGE A17

Criticizing the Smithsonian

Republicans at a House hearing assailed the director of the National Museum of American History. PAGE A13

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A Luminary of Lighting

Dave Dawson, 53, who founded Urban Electric with his wife, created a beacon of “American made.” PAGE A24

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Listen Up

An exhibition at the Cooper Hewitt in Manhattan features ways that rooms have been filled with recorded sound. Right, the Special Model M Phonograph, circa 1935. PAGE C1



Playing for Real Once Again

Cristo Fernandez, once a pro soccer player, joined the “Ted Lasso” cast. Now he's returning to the sport. PAGE C1

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Chez Panisse’s New Act

The Berkeley, Calif., restaurant, credited with changing America's dining scene, has opened a place next door. PAGE D7

The Picnic of Your Dreams

Sandwiches, brownies, icy punch: We have recipes for a delectable spread, and advice on what to avoid. PAGE D4

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Matthew Yglesias

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